neuromatch academy

Welcome, S. Parisa

Teaching Assistant Application - NMA-Computational Neuroscience

What is Neuromatch Academy?

Neuromatch Academy will be an open, online, 3-week intensive tutorial-based computational neuroscience training program (July 5-23, 2021). Participants with broad background from undergraduates to professors as well as those in industry are welcome. Based on last year, we expect 1500+ participants. The Neuromatch Academy Computational Neuroscience course will introduce traditional and emerging computational neuroscience tools, their complementarity, and what they can tell us about the brain. A main focus is not just on using the techniques, but on modeling choices, model creation, model evaluation and understanding how such models relate to biological questions. The school will be Python-based, making use of Google Colab for most students (with alternative mechanisms for participants who cannot access Colab). The Academy will also include professional development / meta-science, and networking sessions. The goal is to give participants the computational background needed to do research in computational neuroscience.

If you would like to volunteer for the NMA in addition to applying, you can visit this page: https://academy.neuromatch.io/volunteer

Overall structure: See the current syllabus design here: https://github.com/NeuromatchAcademy/course-content

Diversity and inclusivity at Neuromatch Academy: Diversity is integral to the Neuromatch Academy mission of providing excellent educational, training, and professional development opportunities to students worldwide. Through nurturing a diverse community, Neuromatch Academy aims to broaden and deepen the educational experiences we provide to students, and to enhance the scholarly environment for teaching assistants, mentors, instructors, and organizers. Neuromatch Academy thus strives to advance inclusive excellence in our student, teaching assistant, instructor, mentor, and organizer populations.

All qualified students, teaching assistant, faculty mentor, and instructor applicants will receive consideration for inclusion in the Neuromatch Academy program without regard to race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, disability, age*, protected veteran status, or other protected categories covered by relevant nondiscrimination policies or laws.

We actively encourage participation for individuals of all races, ethnicities, genders, religions, sexual orientations, gender identities, ages, socioeconomic status, abilities, experiences, and more. Neuromatch Academy will collect voluntary data on the race or gender of its students, employees, contractors and applicants to gauge the effectiveness of its efforts.

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assistants who are under the age of 18.

** This is the application for being a TA in NMA-CN** Thank you for applying to be a TA for Neuromatch Academy: Computational Neuroscience which will be held July 5-July 23. Note TAs will also need to attend online training in the week prior to this (June 28-July 2). We need some more information from you to evaluate all of the applicants. If you would like to withdraw your application, please send an email to support@neuromatch.io with the subject line "TA Application Withdraw".

Please prepare the following materials:

- Send an email to your supervisor at work asking them to fill out this short form (https://airtable.com/shroR57sfy4z4WBss) approving your application and asking to rate your neuroscience and python ability from 1-5. Please complete THIS step as soon as possible! If you do not have a supervisor or advisor to email, please tell us why in the TA form (this will not be counted against you).
- Please make a 5 minute teaching video using our pre-made tutorial, following the instructions here: https://github.com/NeuromatchAcademy/TA-applications/blob/main/README.md
- Find some of your paper abstracts (we will use these to match you to students with similar interests).
- Provide a link to your github profile (if you have one).
- Provide titles of and links to peer-reviewed first author publications (if you have any), or non-first author publications that you contributed to significantly.
- Confirm that you have read and agree with the code of conduct.
- Rate your proficiency in various topics (note this is NOT for selection, this is to help to match TAs with different abilities who can work together, so please be honest). In the event that your TA application is not accepted, if you are interested in being a student in NMA-CN or NMA - DL courses, please fill out the student application(s) as well. Applying as a student will not detract from your chances of being accepted as a TA!

Our Code of Conduct: https://github.com/NeuromatchAcademy/precourse/blob/master/CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md

Consent: By using this form you consent to us storing and using the data you leave here in a number of ways. First, we will share your data with the entire summer school team as the data are essential to make the summer school a success. Second, we will share the data or aspects of the data publicly, for example in the form of participant lists. Third, we will share your data with researchers trying to understand the impact of this program on the scientific community. We will try to keep the aspects of your data that should be private (e.g. names of references) private. We will endeavor to encrypt your data where possible.

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If you encounter problems with the portal, please check our FAQ at this address:

https://academy.neuromatch.io/faq

There is a section on questions related to the application process. If you don't find an answer there please send emails to support@neuromatch.io.

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What do we expect from TAs? Since this is a tutorial-based teaching endeavor and also includes small-group projects, we will need teaching assistants - TAs - to help us run tutorials and provide guidance for small-group projects. Most TAs will be paired with another TA and would be responsible for a small group (~6-10) of participants, all in the same time zone. TAs will be in direct video link contact with their respective group during the 4h lecture-tutorials sessions (1 session/day). TAs are also expected to help with small-group projects (1-2 projects/TA) formed by the same group of participants they're supervising for tutorials. In summary: during the course, this will be a high effort project, requiring 6 synchronous hours with your pod and 2+ hours for preparation and project supervision (total of 8+hour daily commitment), 5 days a week. This includes 6 hours of online teaching and supervising, ~1 hour to prep each day's material, and ~1 hour spent guiding student projects. There will also be 1 week of training before the course (~5-6 hours per day). This year, we may be able to offer students two types of teaching assistance: Course material TAs guide students with their daily tutorials whereas group project TAs help students with their projects only. This will reduce the workload for all TAs. The hourly commitment and pay are the same for both roles. The main difference besides the content is that group project TAs will work with a larger set of students. You can indicate your preference for being either a TA for course material, or a TA for group projects. We can't guarantee your preferred choice, but we will try to accommodate. We will also need Lead TAs, ideally those who TA'd for NMA2020, who have additional leadership responsibilities. These include advising TAs, managing TA absences, and guiding less experienced TAs on content. Lead TAs will need to dedicate an extra week beyond the regular TA preparation to become familiar with several days of NMA content. If you're interested in being a Lead TA, please indicate that in the form below.

What do we offer TAs? The main benefit for TAs will be that they help make neuroscience more awesome, enabling the participants to do better research. We can also offer our appreciation and privileged training on the content of the different tutorials by the lecturers themselves and by their assistants. As such, TAs get a unique opportunity to deepen their knowledge and ask questions directly to the world expert lecturers. We are hoping to provide 1500 USD in compensation (for those TAs legally allowed to accept it, depending on tax or visa details). Additionally, we will provide a teaching letter of

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: you will be matched with one of our faculty mentors for an hour long meeting in which you can receive career advice, etc. Finally, this is an opportunity to make a major difference in computational neuroscience education going forward and we will support promoting those who volunteer their time! **Expertise required?** All TAs need to have some neuroscience background and be proficient in Python, and should have had some exposure to machine learning techniques and modeling in neuroscience. Given the breadth of topics being taught, we absolutely do not expect TAs to be familiar with all of them; rather we are looking for your willingness to acquire the required knowledge so that you can then transmit it to your participant group.

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